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INTERIM REVISION OF
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August 1, 1963

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TAB, INDEX, ADHESIVE
TAB SET, INDEX, ADHESIVE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification UU-T-54E, dated August 1, 1963.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers water soluble adhesive index tabs and strips for identifying segregation in file material, alphabetical or otherwise.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. Tabs shall be furnished in the following types and classes, as specified (see 3.2 and 6.2).

Type I - Cloth.

Class 1 - Individual blank tabs, angle projection.
Class 2 - Individual blank tabs, round projection.
Class 3 - Individual printed tab sets, angle projection.
Class 4 - Individual printed tab sets, round projection.
Class 5 - Blank strips, 6 inch.

Type II - Paper. Individual blank tabs, round projection.

Type III - Plastic. Transparent - plastic covered, insertable 6 inch strip sets.

1.2.2 Colors and sizes. (See 3.2 and 6.2)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-504	-	Plastic Sheet and Film, Cellulose Acetate.
UU-P-31	-	Paper; General Specifications and Methods of Testing.
UU-P-121	-	Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
CCC-T-191	-	Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591	-	Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-645	-	Boxes, Folding, Fiberboard, Heavy Duty.
PPP-T-97	-	Tape; Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

FSC 7510

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Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from the Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.)

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-10377 - Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.
MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a special issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Methods:

T 401 m - 60 - Fiber analysis of paper and paperboard.
T 402 os - 49 - Conditioning paper and paperboard for testing.
T 410 os - 61 - Basis weight of paper and paperboard.
T 411 os - 44 - Thickness and density of paper.
T 414 ts - 65 - Internal tearing resistance of paper.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, New York 10017.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Cloth. The cloth shall have not less than 58 yarns per inch in the warp direction and not less than 52 yarns per inch in the filling direction. The cloth shall have a tearing strength of not less than 200 g. in the warp direction and not less than 150 g. in the filling direction. The cloth of the tab projection shall have a smooth surface suitable to be marked by pencil, or pen without feathering. (See 4.4.1.1)

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3.1.2 Paper.

3.1.2.1 Tabs. The paper shall conform to the physical requirements specified in Table I. The paper stock shall be principally bleached chemical wood pulp. The total unbleached chemical wood or ground wood pulp shall not exceed 5 percent. The paper shall have a smooth, white surface suitable to be marked by pencil or pen without feathering. (See 4.4.1.2)

Table I. Physical Properties

Basis weight (22-1/2 x 28-1/2 inch - 500) pounds	130 ± 5 Percent
Thickness, inch	0.013 ± 5 Percent
Tearing resistance, gram	
Machine Direction	260 (Minimum)
Cross Machine Direction	360 (Minimum)

3.1.2.2 Insert labels, blank and alphabetical. The paper stock shall conform to the physical requirements specified in table II. The paper shall have a smooth, white surface suitable to be marked by pencil or pen without feathering. (See 4.4.1.2)

Table II. Physical properties

Basis weight (25-1/2 x 30-1/2 inch- 500) pounds	110 ± 5 Percent
Thickness, inch	0.0055 ± 5 Percent

3.1.3 Plastic. The plastic shall conform to the requirements for type I of L-P-504. The nominal thickness shall be 0.010 inch, plus or minus 0.001 inch. The transparency of the plastic shall be such so that the legend of the insert label is clearly legible.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Adhesive. The entire inside surfaces of the skirts of the tabs and strips shall be evenly coated with an appropriate adhesive. Only when moisture is directly applied to the adhesive shall it be quickly activated. The adhesive shall not block when tested as specified in 4.4.2.1 and shall have satisfactory adhesive quality to comply with tests specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.2.2 Type I, cloth tab.

3.2.2.1 Classes 1 and 2, individual blank tabs. The tabs shall be of cloth stock, and the tab projection shall be sufficiently reinforced to stand erect. (See 3.1.1)

3.2.2.2 Tab dimensions. Classes 1 and 2 tabs shall be of the dimensions as shown in table III. (See 6.2)

Table III. Type I, classes 1 and 2, individual blank cloth tabs

Unit Quantity	Tab projection length * (Tolerance Plus or Minus 1/16 inch)	Tab projection width ** (Tolerance Plus 1/8 inch)	Skirt width ** (Tolerance Plus 1/8 inch)
	Class 1, angle projection (in inches)		
50	7/16	3/8	3/8
50	3/4	3/8	3/8
50	1	3/8	3/8
	Class 2, round projection (in inches)		
25	21/32	9/16	11/32

*Length is the dimension parallel with edge of item to which attached.
**Width is the dimension taken at right angle to the length of tab.

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3.2.2.3 Unit quantity. The unit quantity shall be as specified in table III.

3.2.2.4 Color. The color of the tabs shall be gray.

3.2.3 Classes 3 and 4, individual printed tabs. The tabs shall be made of cloth stock; and the tab projection shall be sufficiently reinforced to stand erect. (See 3.1.1)

3.2.3.1 Tab dimension. Classes 3 and 4 tabs shall be of the dimensions as shown in table IV. (See 6.2)

Table IV. Type I, classes 3 and 4, individual printed cloth tab sets

Tab legend	Number of tabs per set	Tab projection length *	Tab projection width ** (Tolerance plus 1/8 inch)	Skirt width ** (Tolerance plus 1/8 inch)	Height of legend (Tolerance plus 1/16 inch)
Class 3, angle projection (in inches)					
Alphabet (a)	26	3/8 to 1/2	3/8	7/16	3/16
Alphabet (b)	26	3/8 to 1/2	3/8	7/16	3/16
Numbers (1 to 31)(a)	31	3/8 to 1/2	3/8	7/16	3/16
Numbers (1 to 31)(b)	31	3/8 to 1/2	3/8	7/16	3/16
Numbers (1 to 100)(a)	100	3/8 to 1/2	3/8	7/16	3/16
Months (a)	12	11/16 to 13/16	3/8	7/16	3/16
Months (b)	12	15/16 to 1-1/16	3/8	7/16	3/16
States (a)	52	11/16 to 13/16	1/2	7/16	3/16
States (b)	52	15/16 to 1-1/16	1/2	7/16	3/16
Class 4, round projection (in inches)					
Alphabet (b)	26	19/32 to 23/32	9/16	11/32	3/16

Notes: (a) Side attachment, vertical reading.
(b) Top attachment, horizontal reading.

*Length is the dimension parallel with edge of item to which attached.
**Width is the measurement taken at the right angle to length.

3.2.3.2 Tab legend. The tab projection shall be permanently and legibly marked with legend as indicated in table IV. (See 6.2) The names of months and states may be abbreviated. The sets of 52 shall include the 50 states plus the District of Columbia and Puerto Rico.

3.2.3.3. Sets. The tabs shall be supplied in sets containing the quantities of tabs specified in table IV.

3.2.3.4 Color. The color of the tabs shall be gray.

3.2.4 Class 5, blank 6 inch cloth strips. The strips shall be made of cloth stock; the strip projection shall be sufficiently reinforced to stand erect. The strips shall be designed so that index tabs of the desired length may be cut.

3.2.4.1 Strip dimension. The strips shall be of the dimensions as specified in table V. (See 6.2.)

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Table V. Type I, class 5, blank cloth strips

Unity quantity	Strip length * (Tolerance plus or minus 1/16 inch)	Strip projection width ** (Tolerance plus 1/16 inch)	Skirt width ** (Tolerance plus 1/8 inch)
	inches	inch	inch
12	6	3/8	3/8
12	6	1/2	1/2

*Length is the dimension parallel with the edge of item to which attached.
**Width is the measurement taken at right angle to the length.

3.2.4.2 Unit quantity. The unit quantity shall be as specified in table V.

3.2.4.3 Color. The color of the strips shall be gray.

3.2.5 Type II, blank paper tab.

3.2.5.1 Blank paper tab, round projection. The t-ab shall be made of paper stock, and shall be designed so that when folded will be of double thickness and form an adequate reinforced tab projection.

3.2.5.2 Tab dimension. The tab shall be of the dimension as shown in table VI.

Table VI. Type individual blank paper tab

Unit quantity	Tab projection length * (Tolerance plus or minus 1/16 inch)	Tab projection width ** (Tolerance plus 1/8 inch)	Skirt width ** (Tolerance plus 1/8 inch)
	inch	inch	inch
50	19/32	1/2	5/16

*Length is the dimension parallel with the edge of the item to which attached.
**Width is the measurement taken at right angle to the length.

3.2.5.3 Unit quantity. The unit quantity shall be as specified in table VI.

3.2.5.4 Color. The color of the tab shall be white.

3.2.6 Type III, Plastic strips.

3.2.6.1 Transparent-plastic covered, insertable 6 inch strips. The strips shall be designed so that index tabs of the desired length may be cut. The strip shall consist of a transparent-plastic projection with an aperture, having a double beaded edge, to hold insert label. The projection shall be securely attached to a skirt made of white cloth. The projection shall securely hold insert label as specified in 3.2.6.5 and 3.2.6.6.

3.2.6.2 Strip dimensions and height of legend. The dimensions of the strips and the height of the legend shall conform to the requirements of table VII.

Table VII. Type III, transparent-plastic covered insertable 6 inch strips

Strip projection length * (Tolerance plus 1/16 inch)	Strip projection width ** (Tolerance plus 1/64 inch)	Skirt width ** Tolerance (plus 1/16 inch)	Height of legend
inches	inch	inch	inch
6	1/4	3/8	5/32 to 3/16
6	3/8	3/8	3/16 to 5/16
6	1/3	3/8	3/16 to 5/16
6	1/2	1/2	1/4 to 5/16

*Length is the dimension parallel with the edge of item to which attached.
**Width is the measurement taken at right angle to length.

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3.2.6.3 Sets. Strips of any one size and color shall be furnished in sets containing the following: Two 6 inch plastic strips; not less than 18 inches of blank insert labels (see 3.2.6.5), and two series of alphabet labels (see 3.2.6.6).

3.2.6.4 Colors. The plastic projection strips shall be furnished in the following colors, as specified: Colorless, blue, green, orange, pink, red and yellow. (See 6.2)

3.2.6.5 Blank insert labels. The blank paper insert labels shall be white, and be connected in one continuous strip to facilitate feeding into typewriter. The insert labels shall be of proper size to fit the plastic strip and shall be perforated for ease in tearing apart. The labels shall be either 2 inches long (plus or minus 1/32 inch), or 6 inches long (plus or minus 1/32 inch). The labels shall be scored or perforated lengthwise along the center enabling label to be folded double and easily inserted into the plastic projection.

3.2.6.6 Alphabet insert label. The alphabet insert labels shall be white with black printed letters. The dimensions of the label shall be as specified in 3.2.6.5. The labels shall be printed with a double series of letters in alphabetical order. The height of the letters shall be as specified in table VII. The labels shall be scored or perforated as specified in 3.2.6.5. When the folded label is inserted the same letter shall appear on both sides of the strip.

3.3 Identification marking. Each box or envelope of index tabs or strips shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.4 Workmanship. The adhesive index tabs, strips and insert labels shall be made of such materials and by such processes as to insure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The tabs, strips and insert labels shall be free from all defects which will affect their appearance or serviceability. The tabs and strips of any one type, class, size and color shall be uniform, and the edges shall be clean-cut.

3.5 Shelf life. The tabs or strips shall, under normal storage conditions, retain their serviceability as defined by this specification for not less than 18 months from the time of shipment. Suppliers shall make replacements without charge to the Government, of all tabs or strips failing to meet these requirements.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspection set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection and testing of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications, standards and other documents.

4.1.2 Component testing. Each lot of paper or cloth used in the fabrication of tabs, strips, and insert labels shall be tested in accordance with the applicable test methods specified hereinafter, to determine compliance with the requirement of section 3.

4.1.3 Evidence of compliance. In lieu of using his own facilities, the contractor may submit a report of analysis of component materials from a laboratory acceptable to the Government, whether an independent test facility or laboratory of raw material supplier, as evidence of compliance with the specification requirements. The report of analysis shall include, in addition to the actual test data, the manufacturer's name, the name and address of the testing laboratory, date of test(s), and quantity of material represented by the test report. When certification of compliance or report of analysis are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test to determine the validity of the certification or analysis.

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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All index tabs and strips of the same type, class, size and color presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for purpose of examination and test.

4.2.2 Sampling and inspection for acceptance. Sampling and inspection for acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual inspection. Random sample of boxes or envelopes of tabs or strips shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one box or envelope of tabs or strips, except that ten (10) tabs or two (2) strips, taken at random, shall be examined for defects listed in table IX. The Inspection Level shall be S-3, and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) 2.5 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for end-item tests. Random sample of boxes or envelopes of tabs or strips shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit for each test shall be one box or envelope of tabs or strips, except that ten (10) tabs or two (2) strips, taken at random, shall be tested as specified in 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2. The inspection level shall be S-1, and the AQL 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.5 Sampling of material. A lot shall consist of one shipment of paper or cloth used in the manufacture of tabs, strips or insert labels, and received at one time from one source of supply, and shall be expressed in pounds of paper or square yards of cloth. The sample unit shall be 1000 square inches of paper or cloth. The sample unit shall be selected from each lot of paper or cloth in accordance with table VIII.

Table VIII. Sample Size

Pounds of paper or square yards of cloth	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	4

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination of end item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table IX. Any tab, strip or insert label in the sample having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

Table IX. Visual and dimensional examination

Examine	Defects
Material	Material not as specified.
Type and class	Tabs or strips not type or class specified.
Dimension	Dimensions of tabs or strips not as specified.
Shape	Shape of tabs or strips not as specified.
Color	Color of tabs or strips not as specified. Color of tabs or strips not uniform within the box.
Legend	Legend not as specified.
Workmanship	Tabs or strips not free from sharp or rough edges, or malformations. Insert labels not properly scored or perforated Legend of tabs or insert label illegible or of poor quality.
Identification marking	Boxes or envelopes not marked as specified.

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4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Tests for materials. Samples obtained in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the following tests. Failure to pass the tests shall be considered cause for rejection of the lot, as not meeting the material requirements of this specification.

4.4.1.1 Cloth. The physical properties of component material shall be tested in accordance with the following test methods described in CCC-T-191, to assure compliance with the requirements listed in 3.1.1.

Table XI. Physical properties testing (cloth)

Physical properties *	CCC-T-191
Yarn per inch in woven fabric	Test method No. 5050
Strength of cloth, tearing.	Test method No. 5132

*The supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance for these characteristics.

4.4.1.2 Paper. The physical properties of component material shall be tested in accordance with the applicable TAPPI test methods listed in table XII, to assure compliance with requirements listed in Tables I and II. All samples shall be conditioned and tested under uniform atmospheric conditions as specified in TAPPI Test Method T 402 os-49.

Table XII. Physical properties testing (paper)

Physical properties *	TAPPI Test Methods
Fiber analysis of paper and paper board	T 401 m-60
Conditioning of paper and paperboard testing	T 402 os-49
Basic weight	T 410 os-61
Thickness, inch	T 411 os-44
Tearing resistance	T 414 ts-65

*The supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance for these characteristics.

4.4.2 Tests for end-item. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following tests. Any tab or strip in the sample failing one or more test shall be considered defective. If the number of defective tabs or strips exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.2.1 Blocking of gum. Condition tabs or strips and appropriate number of sheets of bond paper of suitable size at 70° ± 2°F., and 80 ± 2 percent relative humidity for 24 hours. The bond paper shall conform to type III of UU-P-121. At the end of the conditioning period, stack the labels evenly, interleaved with the bond paper, apply a pressure of 4 pounds per square inch to the stack, and allow it to remain in the stated atmospheric condition for another 24 hours. Then, condition the stack at 70° ± 5°F., and 65 ± 2 percent relative humidity with the pressure still applied. The tabs or strips shall be examined for blocking (adherence of the adhesive to the paper).

4.4.2.2 Adhesion of gum. The gummed surface of the skirts of the tabs or strips shall be moistened and applied to bond paper of the same quality specified in 4.4.2.1. After 2 hours of drying, it shall not be possible to remove the tabs or strips without removing the surface of the paper.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Tabs shall be packaged level A or C, as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

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5.1.1 Level A and B.

5.1.1.1 Type I, classes 1, 2, 3, 4 and type II tabs shall be packaged in suitable boxes or sealed, flexible, plastic envelopes. Quantity shall be one set per box or envelope and 12 unit packages per suitable carton.

5.1.1.2 Type I, class 5 strips shall be packaged in suitable boxes or envelopes not exceeding 1-1/2 by 6-1/2 inches. Quantity shall be one set per box and 12 boxes per suitable carton.

5.1.1.3 Type III strips shall be packaged in suitable envelopes not exceeding 2-1/2 by 6-1/2 inches, sealed at both or one end. Envelopes sealed at one end shall have a flap on the open end of sufficient length to retain the contents until used. Quantity shall be one set per envelope and five envelopes per folding paperboard box, carton or sleeve with at least one end closed.

5.1.2 Level C. Tabs and strips shall be packaged in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Tabs and strips, packaged level A or C, shall be packed level A, B, or C, as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Tabs and strips shall be packed in overseas type or class boxes conforming to any of the following specifications:

PPP-B-585 - class 3 - Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Box, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Box, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock Corner.
PPP-B-636 - V3c or V3s - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-645 - Box, Folding, Fiberboard, Heavy Duty.
MIL-B-10377-Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.

Gross weight of wood-cleated boxes shall not exceed 200-pounds, fiber boxes shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Box closures and strapping shall conform to the box specification and the appendix thereto. In lieu of steel strapping, fiber boxes may be reinforced with pressure-sensitive filament tape conforming to PPP-T-97; type IV, applied in accordance with the appendix thereto. Boxes shall be provided with case liners conforming to MIL-L-10547, sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

5.2.2 Level B. Tabs and strips shall be packed in fiber boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Box closures shall conform to the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Tabs and strips shall be packed in containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the regulations of carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, each unit, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Interior packages. Unit and intermediate packages, except envelopes for Type III, shall be marked in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice. Marking shall include Federal stock number, nomenclature and quantity.

5.3.2.2 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with accordance with Standard MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tabs and strips are intended to facilitate the identification of file content.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired option offered herein and procurement document should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class of tabs or strips required (see 1.2).
(c) Color (see 3.2.2.4; 3.2.3.4; 3.2.4.3; 3.2.5.4; 3.2.6.4.
(d) Shape (see 1.2).
(e) Dimension (see 3.2.2.2; 3.2.3.1; 3.2.4.1; 3.2.5.2; 3.2.6.2).
(f) Marking (see 3.2.2.1; 3.2.3.2; 3.2.4; 3.2.5.1; 3.2.6.2; 3.2.6.6).
(g) Level of packaging, packing and marking required (see 5).

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